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Content

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Image Names Gone Bad

I was having a thought today, which has probably occurred to someone along the way but this is the first time I've heard of this. There are a number of systems out in the wild that will let you upload images and will keep them named whatever you choose. Further, once they appear on the page, they have to be called by something (JavaScript or an IMG tag generally). What if we were to name the images something bad? What if we were to turn the name into an XSS vector? Well here are some for you to try out if you like:

I bet there are some systems out there that are otherwise hardened that have this issue. The first one above is simply trying to break out of an image tag. The next two are taking a guess that they may be inside a JavaScript tag. Either way, you get the idea. Could be bad, who knows?

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